

Lecture Notes

General Writing Strategies:

- Sender– Encoded Message—Receiver—Decoded Message
- The literary narrative as a story/event/concept to be communicated
- Written communication is successful when it has a well-developed plot
- Plot: The arrangement of events in a narrative. The sequence of events differ from narrative to narrative. Plot changes accordingly.
- Major types of plots in imaginative narrative: Traditional Freytag's pyramid or linear plot (exposition, rising action, climax, falling action, resolution/catastrophe); Circular plot, Non-linear plot, Open-ended plot, and Interactive plot.
- Plots are important in all forms of writing
- To create good plots, remember:
 - a) Your role and audience expectations
 - b) Audience's requirements
 - c) Channels of communication
 - d) End goal

General plot types: closed-ended, open ended, circular, with multiple possibilities of reaching the end, interactive

Approaching Topics; you may begin with the following methods:

- **Definition** (*Genus/Division*)
- **Comparison** (*Similarity/Difference/Degree*)
- **Relationship** (*Cause/Effect/ Antecedent/ Consequence/Contraries/Contradictions*)
- **Circumstance** (*Possible/Impossible/Past Fact/Future Fact*)
- **Testimony** (*Authority/Testimonials/Statistics/Maxims/Law/Precedents/Examples*)

Generative AI has weaknesses.

- It is programmed to generate answers whether it has appropriate answers or not.
- Students can't blame AI for errors, and they are still accountable for everything they turn in. (From Univ of Kansas: <https://cte.ku.edu/ethical-use-ai-writing-assignments>)
- Possibility of bias/inaccuracy in AI generated data. Human supervision is critical
- AI systems have the potential to strengthen and magnify existing biases in training data. (From "Exploring the ethical landscape of AI in academic writing"; *Egyptian Journal of Forensic Sciences*, 2025)
- Use AI ethically

ETHICAL USES OF AI:

- Ensuring attribution
- Double checking against bias
- Education and training for all researchers
- Necessity for education and training for all recipients of research

Plagiarism: Unacknowledged copying

- Use of archival, existing critical data is fully accepted
- However, acknowledgement is mandatory

Common writing mistakes

a. TENSES (Discontinuity)

Example: Once upon a time there was a king. He is the greatest monarch of all times. Most of the time, he will be planning a war against all neighbouring states.

b. USE ACTIVE VOICE (Example)

When John offers Tim's mother to help with his education, she becomes liberated of a burden.

When John offers to educate Tim, he relieves his mother of a burden.

c. EXCESSIVE WORDINESS/REPETITION

Example: In discussing Tagore's views on education, one **often** claims that children are curious and **often** of mischievous attitude.

d. INCOMPLETE/ INCONGRUOUS SENTENCES

Example: **On the other hand** Tagore feels that we are inert, like dead species of some museum, while lessons are pelted on us. (Where is 'on the one hand'?)

e. TOO MANY IDEAS IN ONE SENTENCE

Example: Although Tagore takes side of the child, which is quite correct too in one sense as the child's growth needs more resources than anybody else in the family, he does add the point of financial background as a family's setback by portraying the difficult life faced by [a character's] widowed mother with two children in a time where the society's moral code for women was skewed.

GENDER SENSITIVE WRITING

Avoid: If one seeks to learn what interests **him**, **he** would eventually make efforts on **his** own.

Be gender inclusive

AVOID ABBREVIATIONS

&, etc., e.g.

Templates drawn from Gerald Graff and Cathy Berkenstein's *They Say, I Say: The Moves that Matter in Academic Writing*

Introduction: How to begin?

1. Beginning with a Debate
2. Stating your position
3. Referring to critical sources

Summary of your main argument and the use of quotations

Body of the Essay: Possible Positions

1. When you disagree with existing ideas and give reasons for it
2. When you agree with existing ideas and continue by adding your own take
3. When you agree and disagree simultaneously
4. Remaining undecided

Toward a Conclusion

Use transitions:

- As a result
- After all
- In short
- Finally
- To summarize
- In sum
- Simply put

Concluding Section: Repeat yourself but differently this time